Lecture-2
20.07.2026

⇒ What is E-commerce?

Ans: E-commerce (Electronic Commerce) is the use of the internet, the web, and mobile platforms to conduct business through digitally enabled commercial transactions between and among organization and individuals.

⇒ Difference between E-commerce & E-business

Feature	E-Commerce	E-Business
1. Core meaning	Buying and selling goods or services online.	Digitally managing all internal and external company operations
2. Boundary Reached	Reaches outside the comp. to connect with customers and suppliers.	Stays inside the company to run internal systems and daily work.
3. Exchange of value	Always involves money or financial transactions.	Does not require a financial exchange or money transfer
4. Scope	A narrower concept (it is a subset of e-business)	A broader concept (it encompasses e-commerce entirely)
5. Main target Audience	Connects with external buyers and sellers directly.	Connects internal employees, departments and operations
6. Primary Goal	Focused on revenue generation and online sales	Focused on improving operational efficiency and workflow.

7. Technology Used	Uses the public internet, web, and mobile platforms	Uses internal ~~work~~ networks, intranets, Enterprise system (ERP)

Q. Why Study E-commerce?

⇒ Technological Shift: E-commerce technology is fundamen-tally different and significantly more powerful than any commercial technology that preceded it.

Commercial Transformation: It introduces structural changes to how commerce operates globally, altering traditional retail and supply models.

Q. Characteristics of Traditional Commerce?

To understand why E-commerce is revolutionary, the points below contrasts it with the key features that defined Traditional commerce:

⇒ Consumers as Passive Targets: Consumers are treated as passive ~~income~~ recipients of marketing messages and mass products pushed by sellers without much direct interaction of feedback. Example: Watching a billboard on a highway — anyone absorb the message as a spectator without any way to click, question or interact on the spot.

⇒ Mass-Marketing Driven: Marketing relies heavily on board mass-media broadcasting. Example: Printing a flyer for a local bakery and distributing it to thousands of households without the info of whether residents buy baked goods or not.

⇒ Sales-Force Driven: Operations depend heavily on physical sales staff to interact with customer. Example: Buying a suit at a physical shop where salesman talks to buyer in person and convinces him to buy that product.

⇒ Fixed Prices: Prices are predetermined by merchants with limited dynamic adjustments. Example. Buying shoes in a shop with 500 BDT price tag that buyer cannot bargain or negotiate lower.

⇒ Information Asymmetry: Merchants possess significantly more information about product quality, true cost and availability than cosumers do. Example: Buying a used car where the dealer knows the engine has hidden problem- but buyer does not.

Leeture_3
21.07.2026

Eight Unique Features of E-Commerce Technology

1. Ubiquity: Technology is available everywhere, anytime, creating a "marketspace" that replaces physical location constraints.

E-Commerce is accessible everywhere at all time. ~~Consumer~~ Consumer can browse online stores 24 hours a day from their home, workplace or mobile phone without visiting physical shop.

2. Global Reach: Technology reaches across national boundaries to connect with customer.

E-Commerce technology breaks down geographic barriers. A merchant can sell goods or services to ~~by~~ buyers in different ~~contries~~ countries like local customer.

3. Universal Stands: There is ~~no~~ one uniform set of internet standards shared globally across platforms.

E-Commerce ~~stands~~ system runs on a single set of shared technology standards defined by the internet. Because systems worldwide use identical technical rules, different software, payment gateways,

4. Information Richness: Detailed, multimedia-rich information combining text, audio and video is delivered to the user.

E-commerce offers an engaging shopping environment by combining images, text descriptions, video demonstrations and audio. This helps consumers to evaluate the quality of that product.

5. Interactivity: Technology enables two-way communication between ~~by~~ buyers and sellers.

E-Commerce platforms allow active user engagement. Consumer can reach for options, ask questions via live chatbots, leave product ratings and feedback.

6. Information Density: The total amount and quality of information available to all market participants increases rapidly while costs decline.

E-Commerce makes market information vast, accurate and cheap to access. Buyers can easily perform real-time price comparisons with minimal effort.

7. Personalization and Customization: Meassages and products can be adjusted according to individual user preferences and behavior.

Online platforms can dynamically adapt marketing content and recommendations to match an individual's personal search history and purchase records. Sellers can also offers options to customers.

8. Social Technology: Technology enables user-guranted content and social network sharing.

E-Commerce encourages consumers to create their own content, such as unboxing videos, photo reviews etc. Users can share experience and can give ratings also.

Types of E-Commerce

E-Commerce is classified either by the market relationship or by the technology platform used for the transaction.

1. Business-to-Customer (B2C): Online business sell products, services, or digital content directly to individual buyers. That means a company opens a virtual storefront where normal buyers browse items. Example: Buying clothes, books or any products directly from Amazon.

2. Business-to-Business (B2B): Businesses sell goods, raw materials or services to other

businesses online. Here companies use digital networks to trade supplies in bulk, manage inventory and coordinate ~~procurement~~ purchasing with partner firms. It represent the largest type of e-commerce by dollar volume.

Example: · A smartphone maker purchasing microchips in bulk from an electronic components market place.

3. Consumer-to-Consumer (C2C): Individual consumer sell goods or services directly to other consumers using an online third-party platfrom. A digital platfrom acts as a mediator or auction host helping regular people list their used or homemade items so other individuals can buy them. Example: Selling a used laptop on eBay, renting a room on Airbnb.

4. Mobile-E-Commerce: (M-Commerce): Commercial transaction conducted over wireless networks using handheld mobile services. Instead of using a desktop computer consumers use mobile apps or mobile browsers on smartphones ~~an~~ to shop, book trips and pay for services. Example:

· Ordering takeout food, booking a ride or pay bills.

5. Social E-Commerce: Transactions enabled and driven by social media networks and online social relationship. Social media platforms integrate shopping tools - such as 'Buy' buttons marketplace sections that allows users to buy item directly from feeds.

Example: Purchasing a product directly through Facebook marketplace.

6. Local - E-Commerce: E-Commerce focused on engaging consumers based on their current location. Online services use location data to connect nearby shoppers with local ~~phyi~~ physical stores, through digital deals and local pickups.

Example: Buying a local resturant discount voucher